

Rizwan Syed

Phone:(716)994-6646

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/rizwan-syed-79b798211>

Mail: syedsrizwansr@gmail.com

Location: Arcade, NY

Senior Systems Administrator with 6+ years of enterprise experience managing Windows-based infrastructure, virtualization platforms, and network systems across hybrid and on-prem environments. Proven track record supporting 1700+ users, maintaining 99.9% uptime, and driving infrastructure modernization, performance optimization, and security improvements.

Expert in Active Directory, Windows Server, VMware, and enterprise networking (switching, routing, VLANs, firewalls). Strong experience implementing backup and disaster recovery solutions (Veeam), infrastructure monitoring, and automation using PowerShell and Python. Recognized for strong documentation practices, cross-team collaboration, and delivering reliable, service-focused IT solutions in dynamic environments, including higher education.

SKILLS

- **Infrastructure Architecture & Engineering:** Enterprise Infrastructure Design, Multi-Site Environments, Systems Architecture, Server & Storage Engineering, High Availability Systems
- **Systems & Platforms:** Windows Server, Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu, CentOS), Active Directory, Group Policy (GPO), DNS, DHCP
- **Cloud & SaaS:** Microsoft 365, Azure AD (Entra ID), Intune, Exchange Online, Hybrid Identity, AWS Fundamentals
- **Virtualization & Storage:** Hyper-V, VDI, Virtual Machines, NAS/DAS, NFS, SMB/CIFS, Storage Optimization, Disaster Recovery
- **Enterprise Systems Administration:** Windows Server (2016/2019/2022), Linux (RHEL, Ubuntu, CentOS), Active Directory, Group Policy (GPO), DNS, DHCP, Microsoft SQL Server (administration, backup, performance tuning)
- **Virtualization & Infrastructure:** VMware vSphere (HA, DRS, cluster management), Hyper-V, 100+ Virtual Machines across multi-host environments, SAN/NAS storage, NFS, SMB/CIFS
- **Networking & Connectivity:** Switching, routing, VLANs, TCP/IP, Firewall administration (NAT, ACLs, segmentation, policy enforcement), VPN and secure remote access technologies, Network troubleshooting (latency, packet loss, DNS, connectivity)
- **Backup, DR & Reliability:** Veeam Backup & Replication (design, implementation, monitoring), Disaster recovery planning, failover testing, data validation, Capacity planning and infrastructure resilience
- **Monitoring & Operations:** SolarWinds, Nagios, Zabbix, Logging, alerting, performance tuning, SLA adherence, Incident response, root cause analysis (RCA)
- **Automation & Scripting:** PowerShell (advanced automation), Python, Bash, Infrastructure automation and operational efficiency
- **Security & Identity:** RBAC, MFA, system hardening, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), hybrid identity, Security best practices, audit readiness (HIPAA-aligned)

EXPERIENCE

Koike Aronson, Inc, New York, IT Security Administrator [May 2025-Present]

- Lead and managed enterprise infrastructure supporting 800+ users across multi-site environments, ensuring high availability, security, and performance
- Administer Windows and Linux servers, Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, and Group Policy within a hybrid identity environment (Microsoft Entra ID)
- Manage VMware environment supporting 100+ VMs with HA, DRS, and resource optimization
- Lead network operations including VLAN configuration, firewall policy management, secure connectivity, and routing
- Implement and manage Veeam backup and disaster recovery solutions, strengthening recovery objectives and data protection
- Monitor infrastructure using enterprise tools, proactively identifying and resolving performance bottlenecks
- Serve as escalation point for complex infrastructure and network issues, collaborating with vendors and internal teams to drive resolution
- Lead infrastructure upgrades and modernization initiatives to improve system reliability and operational efficiency
- Administer and support Microsoft SQL Server environments including backups, performance monitoring, and maintenance
- Support secure remote access solutions and enforce security best practices across systems and networks
- Lead maintenance windows and after-hours operations with minimal service disruption
- Develop and maintain architecture diagrams, SOPs, and operational documentation ensuring consistency and knowledge sharing
- Conduct root cause analysis (RCA) and implement preventive measures to reduce recurring incidents
- Collaborate cross-functionally to drive infrastructure upgrades, automation initiatives, and long-term IT strategy

Holiday Channel, New York, Infrastructure and Systems Engineer [Oct 2024 – May 2025]

- Managed enterprise infrastructure including servers, storage, and network systems in a distributed environment
- Administered Active Directory, RBAC, identity lifecycle management, and hybrid cloud integrations
- Supported switching, routing, firewall configurations, and secure connectivity solutions
- Maintained Veeam-based backup and recovery processes ensuring data integrity and availability
- Monitored infrastructure performance and collaborated with cross-functional teams to resolve system issues
- Supported Azure-based workloads and hybrid cloud services improving scalability and availability

- Documented system configurations, network topology, and operational procedures for improved maintainability

University at Buffalo, New York, Infrastructure and systems [Jan 2024 – Sept2024]

- Administered HPC infrastructure including compute clusters and distributed storage systems
- Managed NFS storage and optimized system performance for research workloads
- Ensured high availability and reliability for academic and research systems
- Collaborated with academic departments and IT teams to troubleshoot and resolve complex infrastructure issues
- Supported service delivery for faculty, researchers, and students in a high-demand environment
- Implemented monitoring and performance improvements to enhance system efficiency
- Partnered with research teams to troubleshoot and resolve performance bottlenecks
- Monitored system health and implemented tuning strategies for optimal resource utilization

Vaya Group, Hyderabad, Systems And Network Administrator [Jun 2022 – May 2023]

- Managed enterprise servers and network infrastructure including switching, routing, firewalls, and VLANs
- Administered Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, and user provisioning processes
- Implemented infrastructure monitoring solutions improving visibility and uptime
- Troubleshoot system and network issues, reducing downtime and improving reliability
- Maintained technical documentation, SOPs, and operational procedures

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Science

December 2024

University at Buffalo, New York, USA

CERTIFICATES

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect
- Microsoft Certified: Windows Server Hybrid Administrator
- Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)

KEY PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led implementation of **Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)** improving security posture and audit readiness across enterprise systems
- Automated user provisioning using PowerShell, reducing onboarding time by 40%
- Implemented enterprise backup and disaster recovery strategy using Veeam
- Led infrastructure improvements reducing downtime and improving system reliability
- Designed RBAC model strengthening security posture and compliance readiness
- Developed runbooks and SOPs improving operational efficiency and team collaboration